

Freelance Rate Card Templates + Pricing Scripts (Never Undersell Again)

RenWork Digital Products

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1. Rate Card Template Framework: The 5-Tier Ladder

Stop offering a single hourly rate. It invites negotiation and undervalues your expertise. Instead, present three distinct packages (Starter, Growth, Premium) plus two add-ons. This framework uses

****anchoring****: the Premium tier makes the Growth tier look like a bargain.

****Tier 1: Starter (The Entry Point)****

- * ****Goal:**** Low-risk trial for new clients.
- * ****Deliverables:**** Minimum viable solution. Limited revisions.
- * ****Pricing:**** Fixed fee based on minimum viable effort.
- * ****Limitations:**** No strategy, no ongoing support, standard turnaround.
- * ****Example (Writing):**** 500-word blog post, 1 revision, 5-day turnaround.

****Tier 2: Growth (The Sweet Spot)****

- * ****Goal:**** Your primary target. Best value for effort/return.
- * ****Deliverables:**** Core service + basic strategy + 2 revisions.
- * ****Pricing:**** 1.5x to 2x the Starter price.
- * ****Limitations:**** Standard support, priority turnaround.
- * ****Example (Writing):**** 1,500-word SEO article + meta description + 1 internal link strategy, 2 revisions, 3-day turnaround.

****Tier 3: Premium (The Anchor)****

- * ****Goal:**** High margin, high touch. For clients who need speed and white-glove service.
- * ****Deliverables:**** Full service + deep strategy + unlimited revisions (within scope) + senior-

level review.

- * **Pricing:** 3x to 4x the Starter price.
- * **Limitations:** None. Direct access to you.
- * **Example (Writing):** 3,000-word long-form pillar page + interview with subject matter expert + full SEO audit + editing, 24-hour turnaround.

Add-On A: Rush Fee

- * **Description:** Expedited delivery (50% faster than standard).
- * **Cost:** +50% of base project fee.

Add-On B: Ongoing Support

- * **Description:** Hourly block for minor tweaks or Q&A post-delivery.
- * **Cost:** Flat monthly fee or hourly rate.

2. Value-Based Pricing Formula

Stop billing for time. Bill for the outcome. Use this formula to calculate your floor price before applying market adjustments.

Formula:

$$\text{Client's Annual Gain from Your Service} \times (12 / \text{Number of Months You Work}) \times 10\% = \text{Your Monthly Value}$$

Worked Example:

You are a B2B Copywriter. A client is struggling with low conversion on their landing page.

1. **Current State:** They get 10 leads/month at \$500 LTV (Lifetime Value) = \$5,000/mo.
2. **Projected State:** Your copy improves conversion by 20%. New leads = 12/month. New revenue = \$6,000/mo.
3. **Annual Gain:** $(\$6,000 - \$5,000) \times 12 = \$12,000/\text{year}$.
4. **Your Share:** You take 10% of that gain to justify your fee.
5. **Calculation:** $\$12,000 \times 10\% = \$1,200/\text{month}$.

If you charge \$500/hour and it takes you 10 hours, your time-based rate is \$5,000. But your value-

based rate is only \$1,200. **Always charge the higher of the two.** In this case, you charge \$5,000. If the gain was higher, you would charge more.

3. Market Rate Benchmarks by Niche (2024 Estimates)

These are *minimum* viable rates for established freelancers. Do not go below these without a compelling strategy reason.

- * **Writing/Copywriting:**

- * Per Word: \$0.15 - \$0.50 (B2B Tech/Finance is on the higher end).

- * Project: \$500 - \$5,000+ for landing pages.

- * **Graphic/UI Design:**

- * Hourly: \$75 - \$150/hr.

- * Project: \$1,500 - \$10,000+ for full brand identity.

- * **Web Development:**

- * Hourly: \$100 - \$200/hr.

- * Project: \$3,000 - \$20,000+ for custom sites.

- * **Digital Marketing (SEO/PPC):**

- * Retainer: \$1,500 - \$5,000/month minimum.

- * Note: Low-retainer marketing accounts are a death trap. Avoid under \$1,500.

- * **Virtual Assistance:**

- * Hourly: \$30 - \$75/hr (Specialized VAs like HubSpot or Salesforce admins charge more).

- * **Consulting/Strategy:**

- * Hourly: \$200 - \$500/hr.

- * Day Rate: \$1,500 - \$3,500/day.

4. Scripts: Presenting Pricing Without Apology

The Setup:

Send the proposal via email or Loom video. Do not present it over a live call unless you have already qualified their budget.

Script:

"Hi [Client Name],

Thanks for the detailed conversation. Based on our discussion, I've put together a proposal that addresses [Key Problem].

I've structured this into three options so you can choose the level of support that best fits your current goals:

1. **Starter:** Focuses on [Core Deliverable]. Ideal for testing the waters. **\$[Price]**

2. **Growth (Recommended):** Includes [Core Deliverable] + [Strategy Element]. This is what most clients in your industry choose to ensure [Specific Outcome]. **\$[Price]**
3. **Premium:** Full white-glove service including [High-Touch Element]. Best for rapid scaling. **\$[Price]**

Let me know if you have questions or if you'd like to move forward with one of these. I'm holding your slot for [Day of Week] to ensure I can start on time.

Best,
[Your Name]"

Key Tactic: Notice there is no "let me know your thoughts." There is a clear call to action and a deadline.

5. Scripts: Handling "Your Rate Is Too High"

Scenario A: The Budget Objection

- * **Client:** "Honestly, this is a bit more than we expected."
- * **You:** "I completely understand. Quality costs. If budget is the primary constraint, we can look at the Starter package, which is \$[Lower Price]. However, that scope would exclude [Key Feature], which means [Negative Consequence]. Would you like to proceed with the Starter scope, or stick with the Growth scope to ensure [Positive Outcome]?"

Scenario B: The Comparison Objection

- * **Client:** "I found someone else offering this for half the price."
- * **You:** "That's very common. There are many freelancers at that price point. The difference is that I include [Specific Differentiator: e.g., 5 years of industry-specific experience / guaranteed ROI tracking / senior-level review]. My clients typically see [Result] within [Timeframe]. Would you like a sample of my recent work in [Niche] to compare the quality?"

Rule: Never lower your price. Reduce the scope. If they can't afford the scope, they aren't the right client.

6. Price Raise Announcement Email Template

Send this 30 days before the increase takes effect.

Subject: Update to my pricing structure for [Year/Quarter]

Hi [Client Name],

I'm writing to share an update to my engagement terms. As my client list grows and demand for my services increases, I am updating my pricing effective [Date].

This change reflects the increased value I've delivered over the past [Time Period], including [Specific Win/Result].

****New Rates Effective [Date]:****

* [Service A]: \$[Old Price] ? \$[New Price]

* [Service B]: \$[Old Price] ? \$[New Price]

To ensure continuity, I have locked in your current rate for one final [Month/Quarter] cycle. After that, the new rates will apply.

I value our partnership and am excited to continue driving [Goal] for your team. Please let me know if you have any questions.

Best,

[Your Name]

7. Services Packaging Guide: Bundling for Retainers

Hourly work is hard to scale. Retainers provide predictable income.

****Step 1: Identify the "Pain Point" Cycle****

What does the client need repeatedly?